Hands-on Landscape-Based Ecological Risk Assessment Using the Open-Source xLandscape Modelling Framework

"A SETAC Europe **training course on landscape modelling** has so much potential to be **engaging, playful, and genuinely memorable**, especially because **the topic sits at the intersection of ecology, spatial thinking, and systems dynamics**." (Copilot March'26)

SETAC Europe, 17 May 2026

Introductory Remarks

SETAC Europe, 17 May 2026

This is the first training course on landscape modelling using the xLandscape framework.

To make up for any gaps in our early-stage preparation, please reach out with questions or roadblocks as you begin using xLandscape in your projects.

thorsten.schad@landwerk-ev.de

Wetterau, Hessian, Germany

I'm Thorsten Schad

thorsten.schad@landwerk-ev.de

Biologist, with a background in physics, math and informatics

27+ years in environmental and landscape modelling, esp. in risk assessment of pesticides

Co-creator of xLandscape

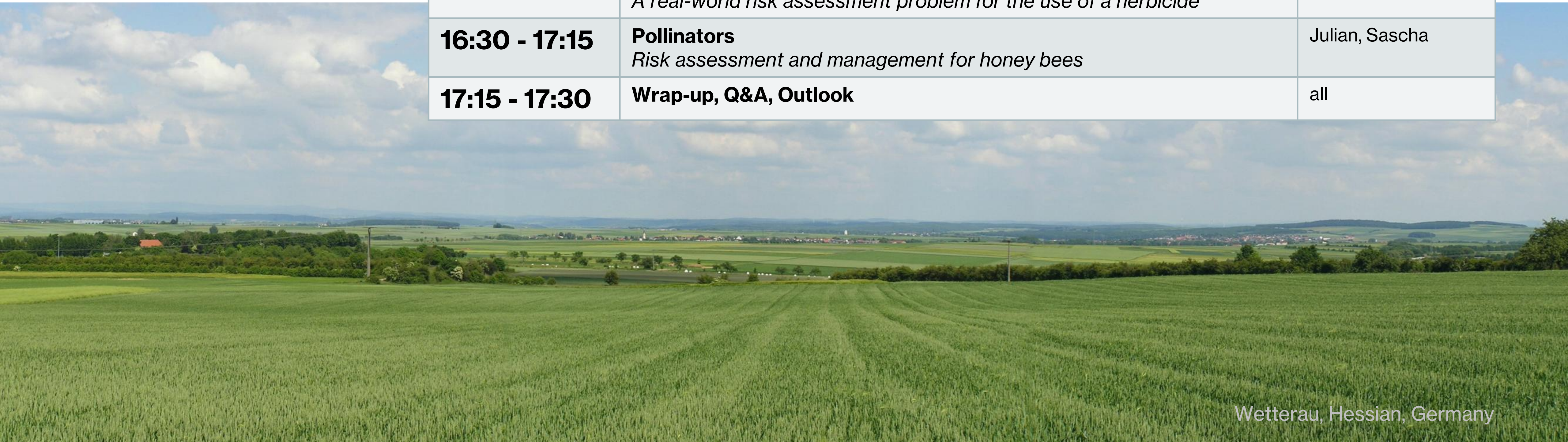
Passionate about cultivated landscapes, balancing human welfare, natural ecosystems and biodiversity

Welcome

Content

13.30 – 17.30

13:30 - 13:50	**Introduction and Fundamentals** *Landscape Modelling in risk assessment of pesticides*	Thorsten
13:50 - 14:15	**Introduction to xLandscape** *Motivation, concepts, design*	Thorsten, Sascha
14:15 - 15:15	**Aquatic Risk of Invertebrates** *A real-world risk assessment problem for the use of an insecticide*	Thorsten
15:15 - 15:30	Coffee Break	
15:30 - 16:30	**Aquatic Risk of Water Plants** *A real-world risk assessment problem for the use of a herbicide*	Sebastian
16:30 - 17:15	**Pollinators** *Risk assessment and management for honey bees*	Julian, Sascha
17:15 - 17:30	**Wrap-up, Q&A, Outlook**	all



Wetterau, Hessian, Germany

The Rise of AI

A game changer for

- xLandscape development
- Analysis, visualization, reporting
- User Interface
- Scenario development
- Documentation, Training

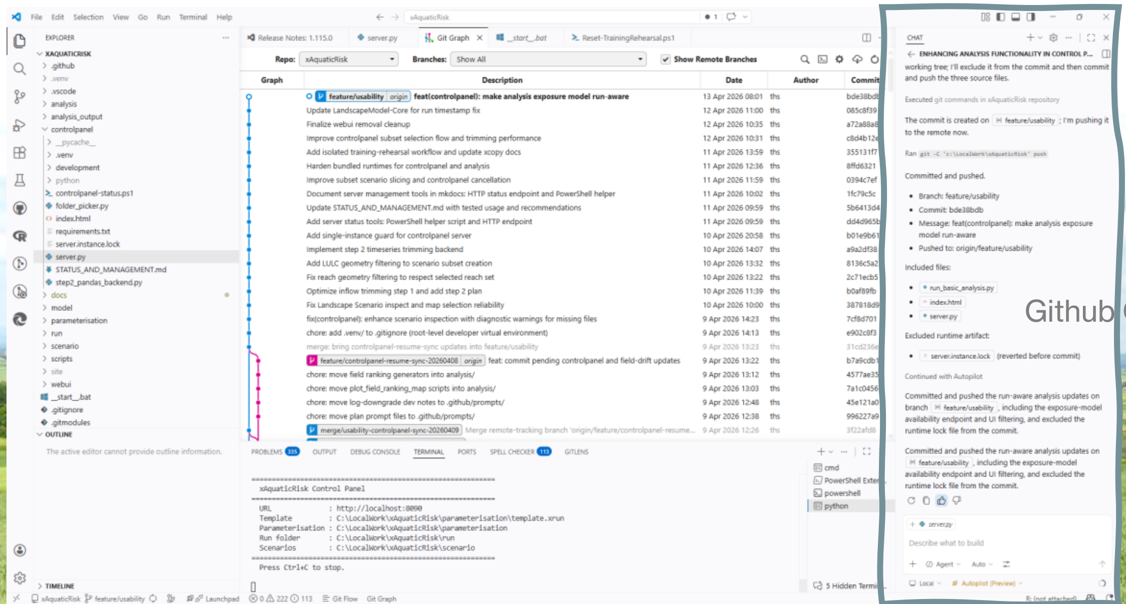
→**Consequences** on training take home

high

AI impact

low

- Technical implementation, model use (User Interface)
- Range of application
- Model Outcome, Analysis, Communication
- **Concepts,** esp. **modularity**. **Architectures**.
- **Motivation** for Landscape Modelling. **Strategies.**
- **Regulatory framework**.



Github Copilot